FREE GUIDE 06 · CAREER EVIDENCE

Before Your Next Review: Capture the Evidence

Turn one recent contribution into a credible story of judgment, impact and shared credit.

At review time, a long task list still leaves the reader asking: ‘So what?’

Useful evidence explains the situation, the choice you made, what changed and how you know. Capture it while the details are fresh. You are building a record someone else can understand and check.

Start here

Choose one contribution from the last month. Find the original brief, decision note or result. Start with the record, rather than reconstructing a more flattering story from memory.

01 Situation

02 Your judgment

03 Observed outcome

04 Evidence and credit

Set aside 20 minutes. Work through the examples, then print page 4 for your own situation.

SEE IT IN PRACTICE

From a familiar response to a useful one.

Fictional examples for practice. Adapt the reasoning to the facts of your situation.

A TASK LIST

Before: Led the onboarding project. Ran weekly meetings. Created the tracker.

After: New client onboarding had no clear owner between Sales and Operations. I compared a centralized queue with a named owner per client, then proposed a four-week pilot of named owners on eight comparable accounts.

The situation and choice reveal your judgment. Meeting frequency alone does not explain your contribution.

THE OBSERVED OUTCOME

Before: Transformed onboarding and increased revenue.

After: Median time from signed contract to first usable setup was 12 days for the prior eight comparable accounts and 8 days for the eight pilot accounts. The samples are small and account complexity varied, so the pilot does not prove causation. We have not measured a revenue effect.

A baseline, definition, period and limitation make the outcome checkable. Do not claim an unmeasured downstream result.

EVIDENCE AND SHARED CREDIT

Before: I delivered a 33% improvement.

After: My contribution was framing the options, securing both teams’ agreement and setting the review criteria. Operations ran the pilot and Sales improved the handover data. The signed pilot brief and onboarding log support the record. We agreed a second pilot before wider rollout.

You make your own role visible without absorbing the team’s work. The next decision shows how the evidence was used.

THE METHOD

What makes a contribution credible?

Describe the stakes

What was at risk or needed to improve? Include scope and constraints. ‘This mattered’ becomes useful when the reader knows to whom and why.

Show the judgment

What did you choose, recommend, negotiate or stop? What was the alternative? Distinguish decisions you owned from decisions you influenced.

Use the evidence you have

A time series, a documented decision, a stakeholder confirmation or a clearer handover can all help. If you have no numeric outcome, describe an observable change and how it was confirmed.

Name limits and shared credit

Record other contributors and uncertainty. Never turn a forecast into a realized saving. If you claim time saved, show the calculation and whether that time was actually redeployed.

Keep this to hand

The situation was [problem and stakes]. I [specific judgment or contribution], choosing [option] over [alternative] because [reason]. We observed [change] over [period], supported by [record]. [People or teams] contributed [work]. We still need to check [limitation].

YOUR PRINTABLE WORKSHEET

Capture one contribution.

Keep source records in your approved workplace systems. Use references here, not confidential documents copied into personal storage.

01 Situation, scope and why it mattered

02 My decision or contribution, and the alternative considered

03 What changed, compared with what and over what period?

04 Evidence location and someone who can confirm it

05 Other contributors, limitations and what is not yet proven

06 A concise review-ready version and the next decision

TAKE IT INTO YOUR WEEK

One useful next move.

Before you use it

Read your completed sheet once. Check each statement below.

- ☐ Someone outside the project can understand why it mattered.
- ☐ My contribution is distinct from the team’s total result.
- ☐ Every outcome is supported or clearly labeled as an estimate.
- ☐ The evidence can be checked in an appropriate system.

Try it once

Set aside ten minutes each Friday to capture one contribution. Before your review, choose the examples most relevant to the scope you want to demonstrate. Ask your manager what evidence is missing. A record supports a conversation; it does not guarantee a promotion.

Afterward, ask yourself

Which example shows a wider scope of judgment? What evidence would make it stronger?

Make the contribution easier to see.

Start with the Leadership Visibility Check. For deeper practice, the course includes twelve lessons and printable workbooks, including The Promotion Case Builder.

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